

Reasoning Reference: Mirror Images

Educational Series

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1 Introduction

A mirror image is the reflection of an object in a mirror. In reasoning, this topic tests the ability to visualize the **lateral inversion** of objects, letters, and numbers.

2 Fundamental Principles

- **Lateral Inversion:** The left side of the object becomes the right side of the image, and vice-versa.
- **Vertical Stability:** The top and bottom of the object remain the same in the mirror image (unlike Water Images).
- **Proximity Rule:** Parts of the object closer to the mirror appear closer in the reflection.

3 Alphabet Mirror Images

3.1 Capital Letters (Invariant)

Some letters do not change their shape in a mirror because they are vertically symmetrical:

A, H, I, M, O, T, U, V, W, X, Y

3.2 Letters that Change

Letters like B, C, D, E, F, G, J, K, L, N, P, Q, R, S, Z undergo lateral inversion.

- **B** becomes Ɔ
- **R** becomes Я
- **S** becomes 2

4 Clock-Based Mirror Images

To find the mirror time without drawing, use these subtraction shortcuts:

1. **If time is between 1:00 and 11:00:**
Subtract the given time from **11:60**.
2. **If time is between 11:00 and 1:00:**
Subtract the given time from **23:60**.

5 Step-by-Step Solving Strategy

1. **Check the Mirror Position:** Usually, the mirror is vertical (on the right). If it is horizontal (at the bottom), it acts as a *Water Image*.
2. **Start from the Right:** The last letter of the word will become the first letter of the mirror image.
3. **Eliminate Options:** Look for letters that haven't been inverted or have been flipped upside down (incorrect).

6 Solved Examples

Example 1: Find the mirror image of the word "REASON".

- The word starts with R and ends with N.
- In the mirror, it will start with an inverted N and end with an inverted R.
- Result: NO2AƎЯ

Example 2: A clock shows 3:25. What is the time in the mirror?

- Subtract 3:25 from 11:60.
- $11 : 60 - 3 : 25 = 8 : 35$.
- **Answer: 8:35**